

Justin Wested

Staff QA Engineer | Quality Assurance Lead

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SUMMARY

Staff-level QA Engineer with 6+ years of professional experience leading quality across autonomous vehicle systems and unreleased game titles. Proven leader in driving ownership across the SDLC, designing and executing test plans, managing defect databases, and translating complex technical issues into clear, actionable insights for stakeholders. Brings rigorous QA methodology to both engineering and creative software environments and delivers high-quality results under pressure.

SKILLS

- **Game QA & Development:** Pre-release Game Testing, NDA-bound Bug Reporting, Cross-Genre & Cross-Platform Testing, Player Experience Feedback, Godot Engine, GDScript, Custom Roll20 Plugins
- **QA:** Test Plan Design and Coverage, Regression Testing, Edge-Case Testing, Functional Testing, Test Automation Strategy, SOP Development
- **Defect Management:** Defect Database Management (Jira), Triage, Monitoring, Prioritization, Root Cause Analysis, Custom Reporting, Data Analysis
- **Process Improvement:** SDLC Quality Ownership, Agile Methodologies, Process Standardization, Workflow Optimization, Creative Problem Solving
- **Technical Proficiency:** Autonomous Vehicle (AV) Systems, Linux, Command Line, Log Analysis, System Diagnostics, Software Tooling Support
- **Collaboration & Leadership:** Cross-functional Team Collaboration, Remote QA Team Mentoring & Tasking, Stakeholder Communication, Training & Onboarding, Technical Documentation (Confluence), Git/GitHub
- **Programming & Scripting:** Python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, PHP, WordPress, SQL, React, Typescript

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mercedes-Benz Research & Development — *Triage Engineer* — November 2023 – Current

- **Proactively triage** and prioritize defects in complex autonomous vehicle systems.
- **Manage defect database (Jira)**, improving clarity and reducing time-to-diagnosis by 30%.
- **Authored test plans** and standardized Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) during a major AV generation transition.
- Acted as the primary knowledge resource for triage processes and system diagnostics, providing technical guidance and training across teams.
- **Created custom reports** on KPIs to translate technical issues into actionable insights for stakeholders and leadership.
- **Championed process improvements** that increased triage efficiency and cross-team communication, **accelerating issue resolution timelines by 25% through creative problem solving.**

Good Gamer Group — *Senior Game Tester (Freelance)* — October 2023 – Current

- **Test unreleased games under NDA** across multiple genres, platforms, and development stages — from prototype to near-release — delivering structured feedback that informs pre-launch decisions.
- **Author detailed feedback reports** combining bug documentation, UX friction analysis, and gameplay balance observations, with clear reproduction steps and prioritized severity.
- **Promoted to Senior Game Tester** in recognition of consistent volume, quality, and articulation of feedback across studies — a tier earned through demonstrated reliability and depth of insight.
- **Apply formal QA methodology to creative software** — including edge-case exploration, scenario-based testing, and structured bug reporting — bringing engineering-grade rigor to qualitative game evaluation.
- **Translate player-experience observations into actionable developer feedback**, balancing constructive criticism with the perspective of a target-audience gamer.
- **Maintain NDA-bound reporting standards** across all engagements, communicating sensitive pre-release findings clearly and professionally.

100Devs — Software Engineer Apprentice (Bootcamp) — January 2022 – November 2023

- **Developed interactive web applications** with a strong focus on UX.
- **Built modular and scalable components**, integrating feedback from collaborative sprint cycles to ensure quality.
- **Built and integrated custom plugins for Roll20**, a tabletop RPG platform — demonstrating game-adjacent development experience and an understanding of player-facing system functionality.
- **Developed lightweight front-end systems for small businesses**, including a shipping/receiving app that automated label scanning and payment matching — tools that simplify workflows and decision-making.

Argo AI — Triage Engineer — July 2017 – December 2021

- **Logged 5+ years and 4,000+ hours** of professional QA work testing and troubleshooting autonomous vehicle systems.
- **Designed and executed test plans** for regression, development, and edge-case scenarios in AVs on closed course and public road environments.
- **Worked with developers and engineering teams** to escalate software bugs and provide continuous feedback.
- Supported technical areas including AV services, software, and tooling by expertly diagnosing complex behaviors.
- Provided visibility on QA progress by authoring clear reports that translated into actionable insights.
- Tasked and mentored new Test Technicians/Test Engineers in effective GUI/tooling usage for testing execution.

EDUCATION

Western Governors University — B.S. Computer Science Expected 2027